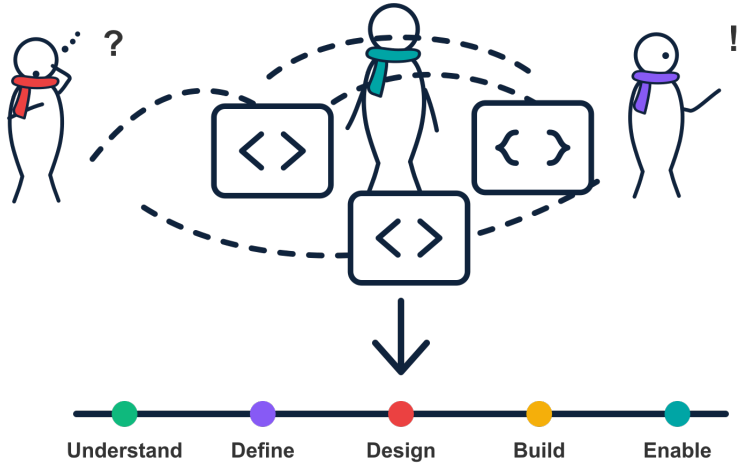
APIOps Cycles

API delivery and digital product thinking



An Australian financial-services case study

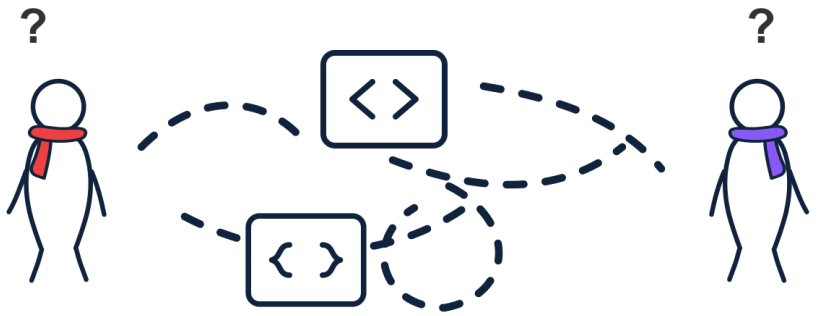
APIsFirst with partner Osaango

The challenge: dependencies across teams

Established API engineering practices

API products still depended on business and technology teams working across organisational boundaries.

Customer journeys and partner integrations had to fit internal services, legacy systems and compliance obligations.



Teams needed shared requirements, clearer ownership and coordinated delivery decisions.

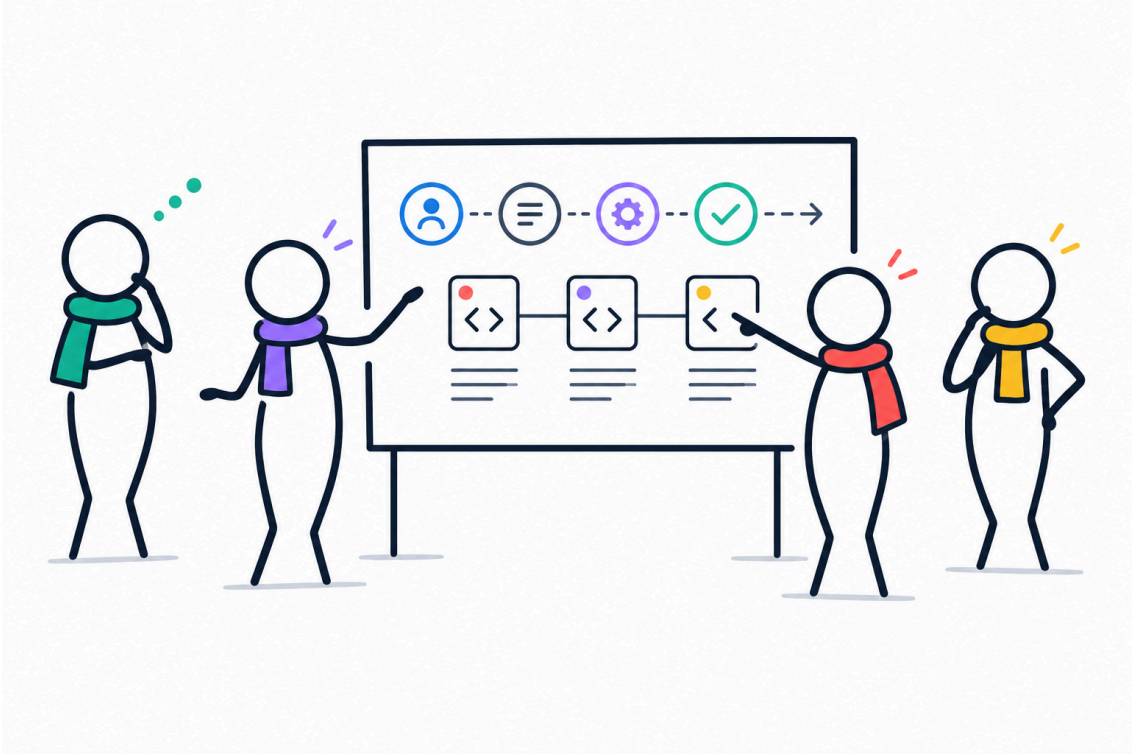
Collaborative discovery in the payments case

What the team did

APIsFirst and Osaango facilitated iterative workshops with business stakeholders, architects and engineers.

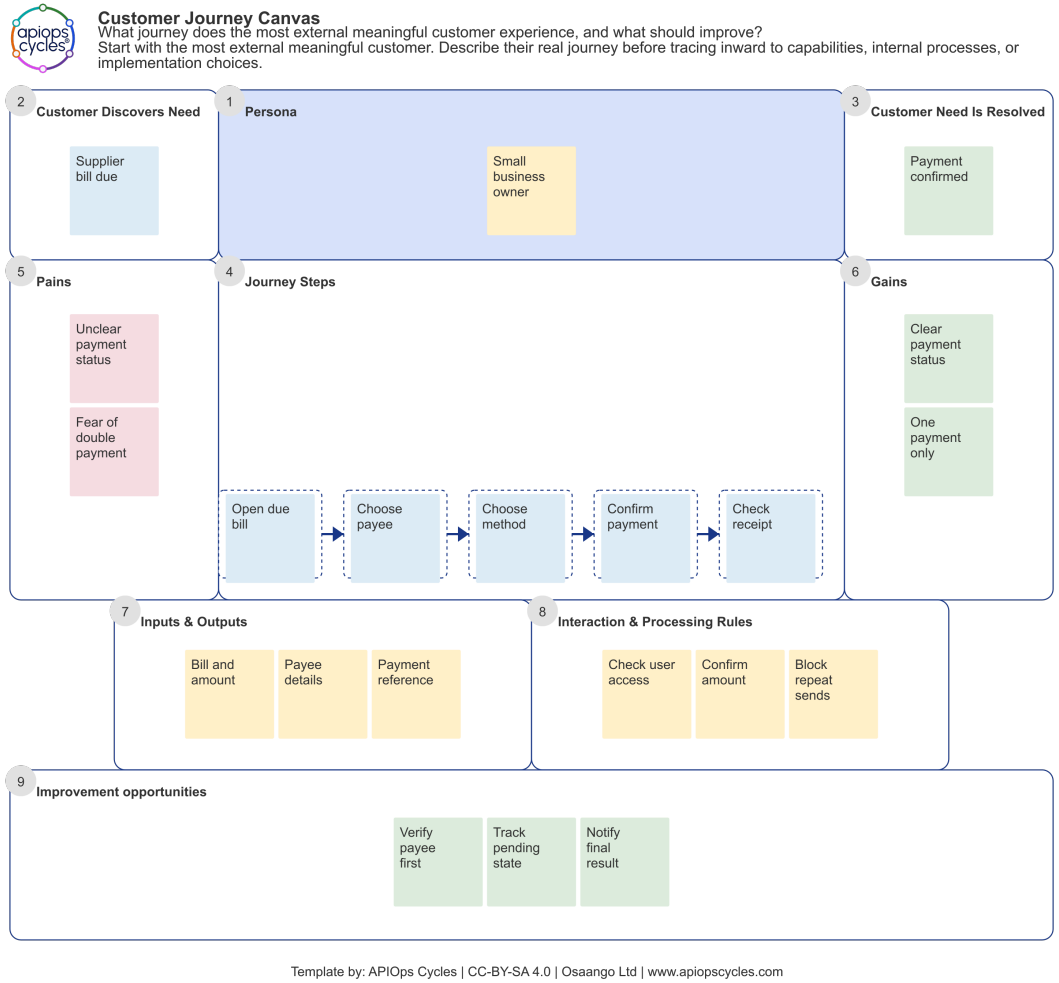
What the canvases made visible

Customer and API consumer journeys, value propositions, business rules and operating constraints.



Payments example: consumer details, payment method access, business risks and internal or partner channel needs.

Customer Journey Canvas: a supplier payment



Customer and trigger

A small business owner has a supplier bill due and wants to know the payment has completed.

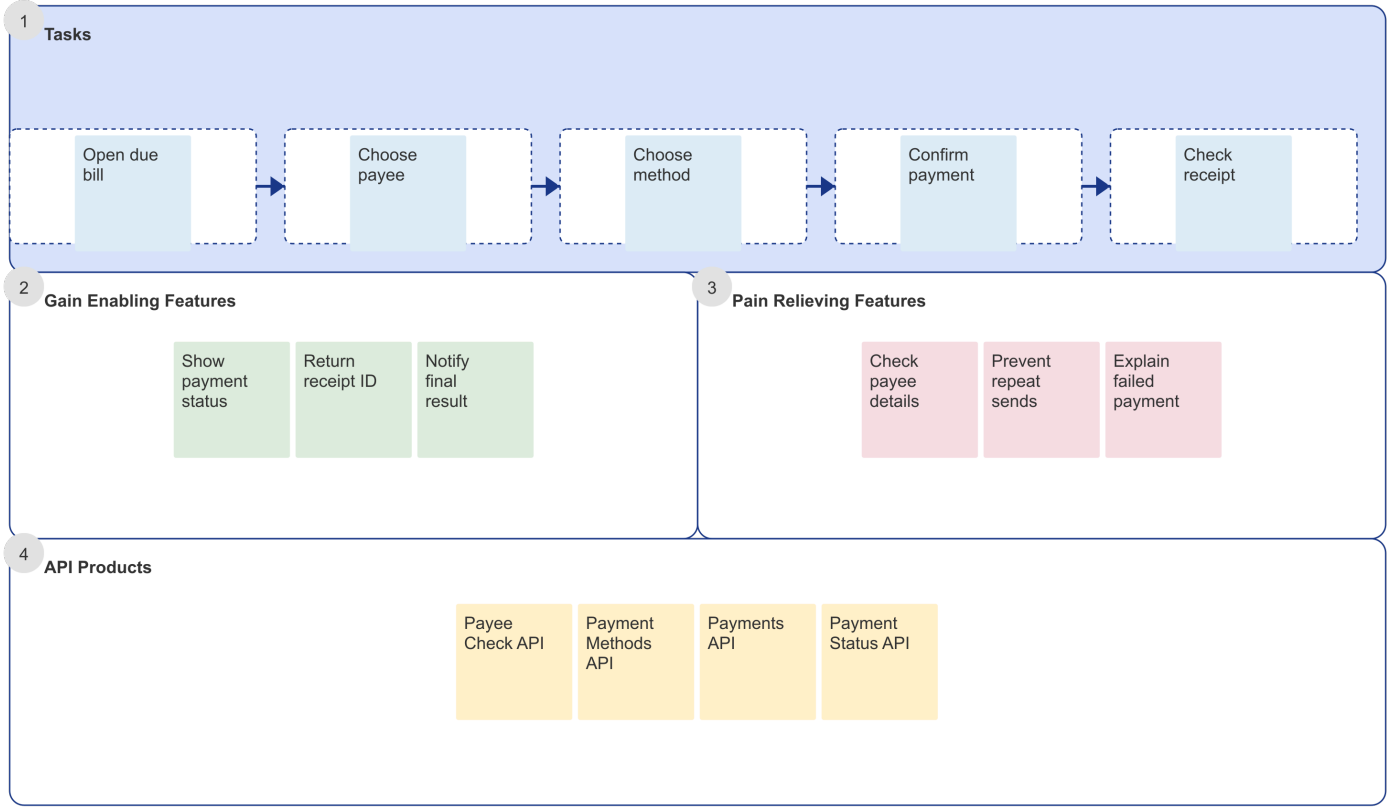
The customer journey

1. Open the due bill
2. Choose the payee
3. Choose a payment method
4. Confirm the payment
5. Check the receipt

Illustrative example. Not a client artefact.

API Value Proposition Canvas: the same journey

API Value Proposition Canvas
How does the customer journey map to APIs? What end-user and API consumer pains, and gains need to be addressed?
Describe the end-users' perspective, starting with their tasks, then their and API consumers' pains and gains, and finally the API's products and features.



Template by: APIOps Cycles | CC-BY-SA 4.0 | Alexander Osterwalder, Osaango Ltd | www.apiopscycles.com

Customer concern to API feature

Unclear payment status: show progress and a receipt.

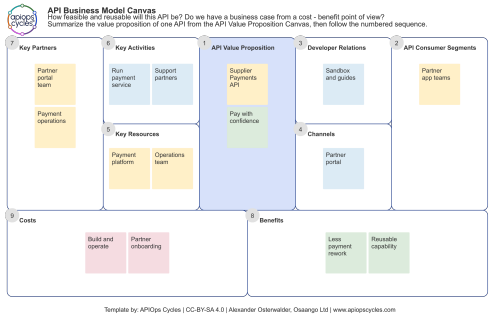
Repeat-payment concern: prevent duplicate submissions.

Candidate API products

- Payee Check API
- Payment Methods API
- Payments API
- Payment Status API

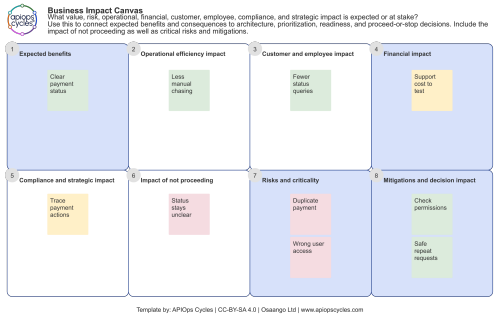
Illustrative example. API names are provisional.

Other canvases supporting API product decisions



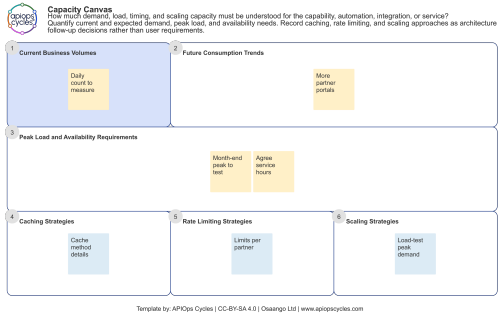
API Business Model Canvas

Value, partners and costs of the payments service



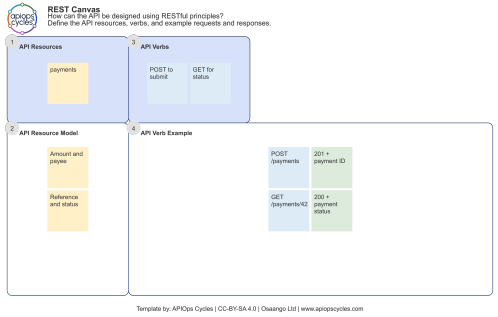
Business Impact Canvas

Expected benefits, consequences and critical risks



Capacity Canvas

Demand baseline, peak load and scaling decisions

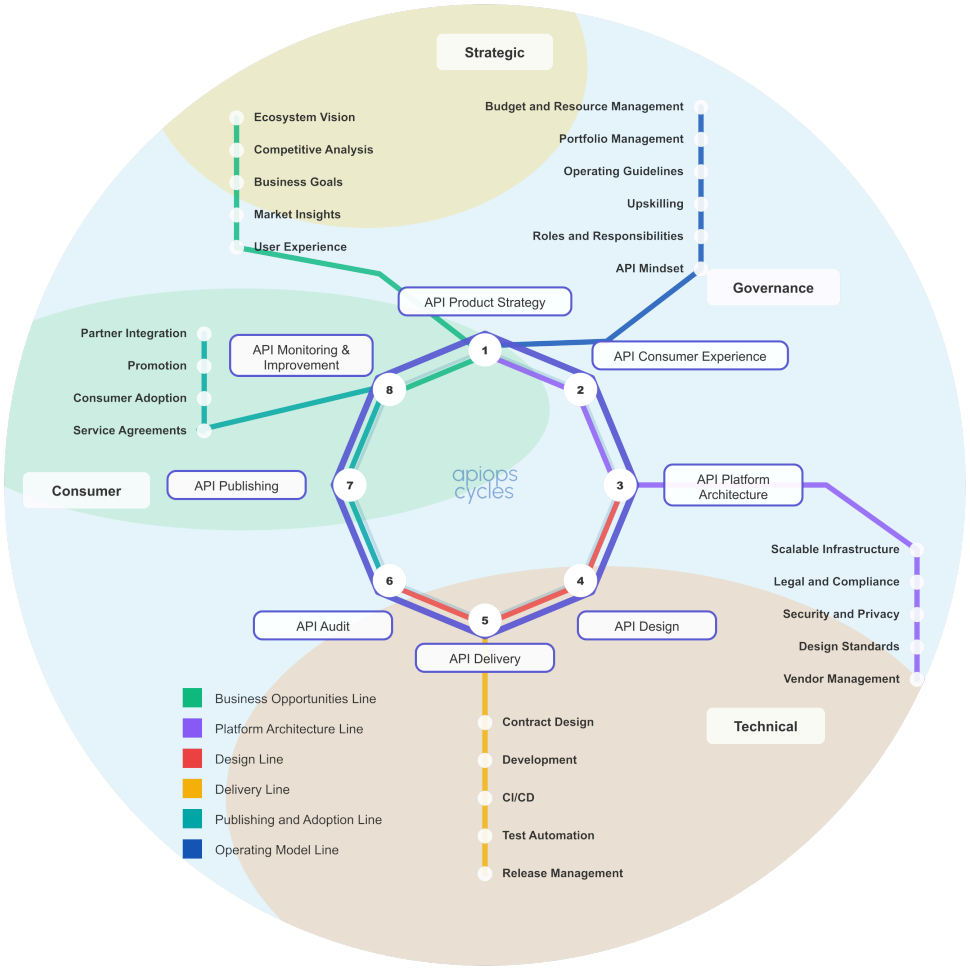


REST API Canvas

Payment resources, verbs and response examples

Illustrative supplier-payment examples. Capacity measurements and assumptions require validation.

API Productization Cycle metro map



One lifecycle connects the work

1. API Product Strategy
2. API Consumer Experience
3. API Platform Architecture
4. API Design
5. API Delivery
6. API Audit
7. API Publishing
8. API Monitoring & Improvement

The engagement connected discovery to design, delivery and testing across these stations.

Discovery informed decisions across the lifecycle

Payment API design connected consumer needs to technical controls

Consumer tasks	Requirements	API design	Controls	Testing
Journeys and channel needs	Business rules and constraints	Domain model and contracts	Access, limits and monitoring	API test automation

Practical support

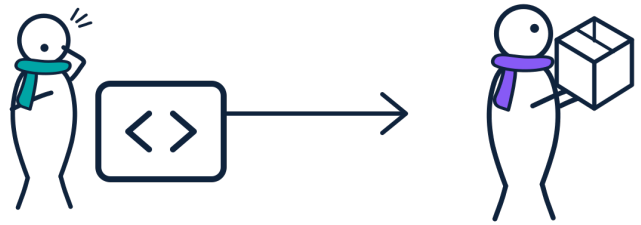
Guidance on API contracts and test automation. Cross-team input on unresolved architecture and security decisions.

AI modernisation guidance

Advice on using AI to convert legacy interfaces while retaining business requirements and constraints.

API product management in everyday work

- Consumers and value: Who uses the API, and what does it help them do?
- Ownership: Who is responsible for the product over its lifecycle?
- Reuse and adoption: How can other teams discover and use the capability?
- Lifecycle decisions: How should the product evolve as needs change?
- Governance and developer experience: How do practices support product outcomes?



Portfolio planning coordinated API releases

Which APIs to create, improve or release, and in what sequence



API portfolio planning

Priorities reflected partner integrations, UI development and dependencies between provider and consumer teams.

Capability improvement

A complementary view addressed API discoverability, governance, developer experience and product management.

The value across products, portfolio and ways of working

Connected work made decisions easier to discuss and repeat

Level	What the engagement connected	Qualitative value
API product	Consumer needs, business rules, contracts and technical controls	Shared understanding and more informed design
API portfolio	Provider and consumer dependencies with API priorities and releases	End-to-end visibility and coordinated delivery
Ways of working	Product ownership and lifecycle decisions with practical methods	Repeatable capability and continuous improvement

Qualitative benefits of the engagement. No quantified delivery or business impact is claimed.